

48 Reported speech overview

48.1 CHANGING REFERENCES IN REPORTED SPEECH

Certain words have variable reference, which means their meaning is context-dependent. In order to retain the meaning of the direct speech, reported speech usually revises tenses, pronouns, and time references.



I **want** to become a police officer.

TENSE

The tense usually moves back.

She said she **wanted** to become a police officer.



48.2 REPORTING VERBS IN THE PRESENT TENSE

The reporting verb can be in the present tense.
In this case, the tense of the sentence doesn't change.

I don't like ice cream.



She **says** she doesn't like ice cream.

Reporting verb is in the present tense.

The main verb doesn't change tense.



I've never tried ice cream.



She **tells** me she's never tried ice cream.

Using "tell" in the present tense can be more emphatic than "say."

